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As AN ACTOR, I guess I spent some of my finest moments in bed—the Gipper's death in *Knute Rockne—All American*, then a scene in *Kings Row*, in which I discovered my legs had been amputated by a sadistic and vindictive surgeon who was angry that I had romanced his daughter.

I started preparing for this scene days before it was filmed. The scene called for me to be unconscious in bed, then awaken, discover my legs were gone, and scream, "Randy [my wife, played by Ann Sheridan], where is the rest of me?" Long before we filmed this scene it was very much on my mind. Would I be semiconscious in my condition and not be able to scream? I wanted to ask doctors what a man in that situation would be like but I never got the chance. Finally, it was the fatal day. When I arrived on the set I found they'd cut a hole in the mattress for my legs and they asked me to get in the bed to see how it felt and looked. When I got under the covers my legs went into the hollowed out section of the mattress. As I lay there looking down the length of the bed, it really looked like my body ended at my hips. From there on, the bed covers were smooth and flat. When they told me I could get up while they lighted the scene, I said, "No, I'll just stay here until you're ready to shoot."

I had experienced a shock at seeing myself with only about two feet of body and I just stayed there looking at where my body ended. The horror didn't ease up. When the camera crew announced they were ready, I whispered to Sam Wood, the director, "No rehearsal—just shoot it." I guess he understood. When he said, "Action," I screamed,